

Tracy J. Johnston

302.423.1123 | tracydjo75@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/tracy-j-johnston-867338a1

Senior Payments & Platform Transformation Leader Payments Infrastructure | Data & AI | Global Platform Modernization

Senior payments and enterprise technology transformation leader with 15+ years of experience delivering complex payments, fintech, data, AI, cloud, and platform modernization initiatives across highly regulated environments. Deep experience translating business and customer needs into technical strategies, roadmaps, operating models, and measurable outcomes across payment platforms, digital experiences, data products, and enterprise integrations. Proven ability to partner with Engineering, Product, Architecture, Data, Risk, Compliance, Finance, and executive leadership to navigate ambiguity, manage dependencies, mitigate technical and operational risk, and drive initiatives from concept through adoption. Combines systems thinking, analytical rigor, and customer-centric leadership with hands-on experience across global payments and transactional technology environments.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Payments & Financial Platforms: Payments Technology | Merchant Onboarding | Payment Gateways | Transactional Platforms | Payment Integrations | Financial Services | Payment Operations | Digital Commerce

Platform & Product Strategy: Platform Strategy | Product Roadmaps | Technical Product Leadership | Platform Modernization | Requirements | SDLC | Launch Readiness | Operational Excellence

Technical & Data Leadership: Data Platforms | Data Pipelines | Cloud Architecture | GCP | AWS | Snowflake | Databricks | APIs | Microservices | Interoperability

Risk, Compliance & Trust: Payments Risk | Regulatory Readiness | Compliance | InfoSec | Security Governance | Authority-to-Operate | Risk Management

Enterprise Leadership: Cross-Functional Leadership | Engineering Partnership | Executive Communication | Stakeholder Alignment | Dependency Management | KPI/OKR Frameworks | Change Management

PAYMENTS & PLATFORM EXPERIENCE

Payments: Global Payments | Elavon | Merchant Onboarding | Payment Gateways | E-Commerce Integrations | Transactional Technology

Platforms: Platform Modernization | Cloud Platforms | Data Platforms | APIs | Microservices | Distributed Systems | Interoperability

Customer & Business Value: Digital Experiences | Customer Data | Self-Service Analytics | Data Monetization | Operational Efficiency | Revenue Generation

Trust & Resilience: Risk Management | Compliance | Security | Architecture Governance | Regulatory Readiness | Platform Telemetry

EDUCATION

MBA, Management Information Systems — Wilmington University

B.S., Organizational Management — Wilmington University

CERTIFICATIONS

PMP | SAFe Practice Consultant (SPC 6.0) | Scrum Master | Product Owner/Product Manager | Release Train Engineer

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Global Payments (11/2021 - Present)

Enterprise Strategic Program Lead (Data, AI & Platform) | Remote (1/2025 - Present)

- Drive enterprise payments, data, AI, and platform transformation initiatives, translating strategic business objectives into roadmaps, technical workstreams, milestones, dependencies, governance, and measurable outcomes.
- Partner across Engineering, Product, Architecture, Data, Security, Risk, Compliance, Finance, and business leadership to define scope, resolve technical dependencies, mitigate delivery risk, and drive complex platform initiatives to execution.
- Evaluate platform architecture, data pipelines, interoperability, governance, and AI readiness, connecting technical decisions to enterprise strategy, operational performance, and customer/business value.

- Identify opportunities to rationalize redundant platforms and redirect investment toward higher-value payments, data, and platform capabilities.
- Launched a data monetization initiative leveraging a Snowflake-based prediction model to create a value-added service for Independent Sales Organizations (ISOs) and generate a new enterprise revenue stream.
- Establish scalable operating models, governance mechanisms, and execution rhythms across enterprise data and AI platforms.
- Integrated technical architecture, risk, security, and Authority-to-Operate reviews into delivery processes, addressing compliance and platform-readiness risks estimated at \$2.5M.
- Recovered a \$10M data platform modernization initiative, increasing data-ingestion performance 30% and enabling self-service analytics across 15+ business units.
- Prioritized reusable ingestion and telemetry capabilities across five business domains, reducing duplicated downstream engineering effort and improving platform scalability.

Enterprise Strategic Program Lead (Cloud & Platform) | Remote

(8/2023 - 12/2024)

- Directed technical transformation across payments and financial technology platforms, modernizing legacy architectures into distributed GCP and Snowflake environments.
- Partnered with Engineering, Architecture, Data, InfoSec, Compliance, and business teams to define delivery strategy, technical dependencies, risk mitigation, and launch readiness.
- Developed cross-functional execution models supporting complex payment-platform modernization and go-to-market initiatives.
- Implemented dependency tracking and security escalation mechanisms that accelerated projected delivery by three months, supporting \$15M+ in projected business value.
- Designed and launched enterprise risk-review and Authority-to-Operate processes across 80+ resources, reducing security approval cycle times and improving regulatory readiness.
- Managed Agile Release Trains and cross-functional teams through complex platform initiatives, balancing technical execution, operational resilience, and organizational readiness.

Director, Strategic Initiatives - Transformation Management Office | Remote

(11/2021 - 8/2023)

- Led enterprise transformation across cloud, platform modernization, M&A integration, and customer-data initiatives, aligning complex technology programs with business outcomes.
- Served as strategic advisor to C-level and Board stakeholders, providing portfolio visibility, executive decision support, dependency management, and delivery-risk escalation.
- Improved initiative-prioritization alignment 25% through an enterprise OKR-based intake and roadmap-planning model.
- Increased stakeholder satisfaction 35% through transformation health scoring, executive communications, and improved delivery transparency.
- Created reusable enterprise frameworks for intake, dependency management, escalation, governance, and execution, improving consistency across complex initiatives.
- Directed post-merger integration across business operations, technology platforms, and customer-data pipelines, including integration sequencing and executive readiness.
- Mentored technical program managers and cross-functional leaders to improve execution maturity and organizational effectiveness.

Insight Global

Enterprise Agile Transformation Consultant | Atlanta, GA

(6/2021 - 11/2021)

- Engaged as an enterprise transformation consultant; assignment concluded early following executive recruitment to join a Transformation Management Office leading modernization programs.
- Advised enterprise technology leaders on Agile-at-scale transformation, operating model design, and delivery governance to accelerate modernization and execution maturity.
- Led Agile maturity assessments, transformation roadmaps, and rollout planning to guide organizations transitioning from project based delivery to product and value stream based delivery models.
- Designed and rolled out an Enterprise Agile governance model, reducing delivery escalations, improving forecasting accuracy by 28%, and enabling leadership visibility into program-level blockers.
- Increased average team velocity by 25% across agile teams within two quarters by implementing PI Planning, backlog readiness criteria, and cross-team coordination rituals.

US Bank/Elavon

(6/2015 - 6/2021)

Assistant Vice President - Agile Support Office | Atlanta, GA

(9/2019 - 6/2021)

- Scaled enterprise digital transformation from pilot through multi-portfolio adoption, establishing governance, intake, delivery, and performance-management practices.

- Led modernization initiatives involving digital merchant onboarding, payment gateways, e-commerce integrations, SOA, and microservices across business and technology teams.
- Built and led blended onshore/offshore teams supporting enterprise modernization and digital payment experiences.
- Developed data-driven executive reporting that improved decision-making, delivery transparency, and operational performance.

Enterprise Agile Transformation Leader | Atlanta, GA

(7/2017 - 9/2019)

- Selected by Senior Vice President to co-lead launch of the enterprise Agile transformation with my Senior Director, designing initial rollout strategy, change approach, and delivery frameworks to transition technology teams to the SAFe framework.
- Led enterprise SAFe Agile transformation across 150+ team members and five portfolios, establishing Agile Release Trains (ARTs), Value Streams, and Lean-Agile Center of Excellence, achieving 80% agile maturity within nine months based on internal capability assessments.
- Transitioned technology teams from waterfall to Agile delivery models, embedding continuous feedback loops and strengthening cross-functional alignment across Product, Engineering, and Compliance.
- Increased stakeholder satisfaction by 35%, as measured through quarterly NPS-style feedback, and aligning OKRs with Agile delivery cadences.
- Owned the enterprise transformation backlog and drove continuous improvement initiatives to sustain adoption of new Agile operating practices.

Manager - Enterprise Digital Transformation | Atlanta, GA

(6/2015 - 7/2017)

- Led digital transformation initiatives involving merchant onboarding, payment gateways, e-commerce integrations, SOA, and microservices across business and technology teams.
- Modernized digital payment experiences by translating business and customer requirements into technology roadmaps, delivery plans, and cross-functional execution.
- Built and led blended onshore/offshore teams supporting enterprise modernization initiatives and payment-related digital experiences.
- Established portfolio governance and performance-management practices that improved execution visibility and strategic alignment.
- Developed data-driven reporting and performance insights to support technology and business decision-making.

Atlanta Group Systems, Inc (AGSI)

Digital Transformation Consultant | Atlanta, GA

(9/2014 - 5/2015)

- Led and successfully managed two client engagements, steering an enterprise-wide IT program for Safe-Guard Products and Elavon, a global payment acquirer.
- Directed the implementation of a digital claims processing platform for Safe-Guard, leading a cross-functional team to improve claims resolution time by 40% and enhance customer experience.
- Collaborated closely with Safe-Guard's executive leadership to develop and execute a transformation roadmap, ensuring milestones were met within scope, schedule, and budget constraints.
- Led a digital transformation pilot to modernize portfolio management capabilities, aligning technology modernization initiatives with enterprise strategy to improve operational efficiency and cost performance for several domains within Global Technologies for Elavon.
- Delivered a comprehensive program playbook, defining roadmaps, and developing communication plans.
- Managed cross-functional change initiatives to embed new digital operating practices, improve technology adoption, and strengthen alignment between business and IT execution.

Aquilent

Associate Consultant - Sr Project Manager | Baltimore, MD

(7/2013 - 6/2014)

- Managed the end-to-end SDLC for the SeaPort-e portal, a comprehensive government acquisition and contract data solution.
- Enhanced functionalities for contract creation, routing, and approval processes, ensuring efficient creation, routing, approval, and distribution of acquisition and contract data.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams, including developers, UX/UI designers, and QA testers, to ensure timely delivery of project milestones and adherence to technical and compliance standards.

Avaya Government Solutions

Digital Transformation Project Manager | Washington, D.C.

(3/2010 - 3/2013)

- Managed modernization of the Federal Judiciary's Next Generation CM/ECF platform across complex technical, operational, and stakeholder environments.
- Coordinated 100+ stakeholders across judges, clerks, IT teams, and vendors through multi-phase implementation.
- Translated end-user requirements into development priorities and managed migration of legacy data and workflows across 10+ federal court systems.